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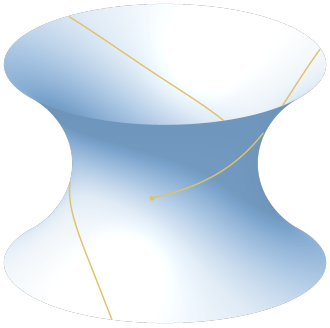
Federal Fraud Expansion
Working Document

Top 33 agencies by budget

Landscape and prioritization

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$$\mathcal{G}(x) = x^x \qquad \nabla_{\dot\gamma}\dot\gamma = 0$$

We navigate our clients from a challenging problem to a defensible solution along the shortest rigorous path.

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As of: 2026-10-27. Public data only. Scores are our judgment from the sources in each brief; they are a starting point for discussion, not a measured result. This extends landscape.pdf, which covers the eight agencies in DOJ's whistleblower program, to the 33 largest agencies.

1 Bottom line

Budget size and fraud opportunity are not the same list. Treasury and SSA are the 2nd and 3rd largest agencies but rank 8th and 22nd here, because taxpayer and beneficiary data are not public. The top of the list is where large fraud-prone spending meets record-level public data: **HHS, DoD and SBA** as before, then **USDA and DHS**, then **DOT and GSA**.

Three new agencies stand out:

- **DHS (customs and FEMA)** is the biggest new opportunity. Tariff evasion through shell importers and false country of origin is a top DOJ priority (Trade Fraud Task Force, August 2025) and looks like SBA shell-entity fraud.
- **DOT** is the fastest technical win: Disadvantaged Business Enterprise fronts are the same pattern as SBA 8(a) fronts, and states publish DBE directories and bid tabs.
- **GSA** owns SAM.gov and FPDS, the data spine for every brief. A GSA partnership improves the data for all 33.

Below the top 15, most agencies are either small spenders or have little public payee data. Their best use is to join shared screens (contractors, research awards, grantees) rather than to get their own projects.

2 Which agencies, and how we measured budget

- **Source:** USAspending.gov agency list (`/api/v2/references/toptier_agencies/`), pulled 2026-10-27.
- **Fiscal year:** FY2026, all four quarters (October 2025 to September 2026), as reported by agencies to USAspending. Figures may be revised.
- **Measure:** we ranked by **outlays** (money actually paid out). We also record **total budgetary resources**, which USAspending labels `budget_authority_amount`; it includes balances carried over from prior years, so it overstates insurance funds (FDIC, PBGC) and multi-year programs. Ranking by budgetary resources would swap in the Farm Credit System Insurance Corporation, Millennium Challenge Corporation and CFTC for FCC, PCORTF and NRC; the top 25 are nearly the same either way.
- **What is counted as an agency:** USAspending's "toptier agency" list, as is. That list includes one trust fund (PCORTF) and omits off-budget or non-reporting bodies such as the Postal Service, Tennessee Valley Authority and Railroad Retirement Board (about $5.1B net in FY2026 per Treasury's Monthly Treasury Statement), and the legislative and judicial branches.
- **Cross-check:** Treasury's Monthly Treasury Statement (Table 5, 2026-09-30) gives the same top tier. Totals differ (for example DoD $917B net in MTS versus $1,345B in USAspending, which also counts military trust funds), but the ranking is stable.
- Raw figures: data/top33_fy2026.csv.



3 How we scored

Same method as landscape.pdf: each agency gets 1 to 5 on four factors, weighted toward what we can do with public data alone.

Factor	Weight	What 5 means
Exposure	30%	Tens of billions a year in improper payments or fraud-prone spend
Public data	30%	Record-level data that names payees (providers, contractors, retailers)
SBA method fit	20%	The SBA patterns (shell entities, shared identifiers, stacked awards, ineligible recipients) apply directly
Actionability	20%	Active enforcement priority and a clear owner to take findings to

Score = 0.3 × Exposure + 0.3 × Public data + 0.2 × SBA fit + 0.2 × Action. Scores for the original eight are unchanged from landscape.pdf.

4 Ranking

"Budget rank" is the agency's place by FY2026 outlays; outlays are in billions of dollars.

Rank	Agency	Budget rank	Outlays ($B)	Exposure	Public data	SBA fit	Action	Score	First prototype
1	Health and Human Services	1	2,687	5	5	4	5	**4.8**	Hospice and home health provider risk map
2	Defense (War)	4	1,345	4	5	5	3	**4.3**	Set-aside contractor integrity screen
3	Small Business Administration (baseline)	22	15	3	5	5	4	**4.2**	Extend current work to 7(a), 504 and 8(a)
4	Agriculture	7	220	4	3	4	5	**3.9**	SNAP retailer and child meal sponsor anomalies
4	Homeland Security (CBP, FEMA)	6	259	4	3	4	5	**3.9**	Tariff-evasion importer lead list
6	Transportation	10	125	3	4	5	3	**3.7**	DBE front and bid rotation screen
6	General Services Administration	16	38	2	5	5	3	**3.7**	SAM.gov registration integrity report
8	Treasury (IRS)	2	1,975	5	2	3	4	**3.5**	EITC hot-spot map by ZIP
8	Veterans Affairs	5	419	3	4	4	3	**3.5**	SDVOSB contract and GI Bill school screen
8	Federal Communications Commission (USF)	25	10	3	4	4	3	**3.5**	E-Rate provider and consultant network map
11	Office of Personnel Management	8	201	4	3	3	3	**3.3**	FEHB exclusion-list reconciliation
11	Energy	13	63	3	4	4	2	**3.3**	Cross-agency SBIR duplicate-award screen
11	Commerce	20	20	3	4	4	2	**3.3**	BEAD subgrantee screen
14	Army Corps of Engineers	18	28	2	4	4	3	**3.2**	DoD contractor screen on Corps awards

Rank	Agency	Budget rank	Outlays ($B)	Exposure	Public data	SBA fit	Action	Score	First prototype
15	Environmental Protection Agency	21	17	3	4	3	2	**3.1**	Grantee profile for large IRA programs
16	Housing and Urban Development	11	85	3	3	3	3	**3.0**	Multifamily owner network and disaster grant screen
16	State (incl. foreign assistance)	15	39	3	3	3	3	**3.0**	Implementing-partner risk profile
16	NASA	19	23	2	4	4	2	**3.0**	Join the SBIR duplicate-award screen
16	National Science Foundation	26	8.1	2	4	4	2	**3.0**	Test bed for the SBIR duplicate-award screen
20	Justice	14	52	2	3	3	4	**2.9**	Press-release case database (labels for all)
21	Securities and Exchange Commission	28	1.8	1	5	3	2	**2.8**	EDGAR enrichment for the entity spine
22	Education	9	135	2	3	3	3	**2.7**	Ghost student risk by college
22	Social Security Administration	3	1,664	4	1	2	4	**2.7**	County SSI outlier map and death-data case
24	USAID (winding down)	23	12	2	3	3	2	**2.5**	Close-out balance and partner table
24	Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation	24	11	3	2	2	3	**2.5**	SFA application vs. Form 5500 check
26	Labor	12	63	3	1	2	4	**2.4**	State UI anomaly dashboard
27	Interior	17	37	2	3	2	2	**2.3**	Royalty-rate outlier table
27	FDIC	27	4.6	2	3	2	2	**2.3**	PPP lender risk table
29	Development Finance Corporation	29	1.6	2	3	2	1	**2.1**	Sponsor sanctions and exclusions check
30	AmeriCorps	30	1.2	1	3	2	2	**2.0**	Foster Grandparent grantee risk list
31	PCOR Trust Fund	31	1.1	1	3	2	1	**1.8**	Join the research award screen
31	Nuclear Regulatory Commission	32	0.9	1	3	2	1	**1.8**	None; include in contractor screen
33	Executive Office of the President	33	0.9	1	2	1	1	**1.3**	None; audience for the proposal

5 Recommended sequence

1. **Now (unchanged): HHS and DoD,** with SBA as the baseline.
2. **Next: DHS customs, USDA, DOT.** DHS and USDA have the strongest enforcement pull; DOT reuses the SBA front-company code with new state data.
3. **Data partners in parallel: GSA, DOJ, SEC, SSA.** Each makes the shared pipeline better: GSA for SAM.gov and FPDS, DOJ for labeled cases, SEC for ownership, SSA for death data.
4. **Contained pilots: FCC (E-Rate) and OPM (FEHB exclusions).** Small, data-rich, and quick to show results.
5. **Shared screens instead of separate projects** for the rest: one contractor screen (DoD, USACE, NASA, NRC, State), one research award screen (DOE, NSF, NASA, PCORTF), one grantee screen (EPA, DOJ, AmeriCorps, Commerce).



6. **Proposal first, data later: Treasury, SSA, Labor, PBGC.** Big money, but the payee data is confidential, so lead with a data-access proposal.

6 Shared screens

Grouping agencies by the screen they need keeps the build to a handful of reusable tools.

Screen	Core data	Agencies
Provider integrity	CMS files, NPPES, LEIE, ownership	HHS, OPM, VA
Contractor integrity	SAM.gov, FPDS, SBA certifications	DoD, VA, GSA, USACE, DHS, NASA, DOE, State, NRC, SBA
Small business fronts	SBA and state DBE directories, subawards	SBA, DoD, DOT, VA
Research awards	SBIR.gov, NSF, NIH RePORTER, PCORI	DOE, NSF, NASA, PCORTF, DoD
Grantees and nonprofits	USAspending subawards, Form 990	EPA, DOJ, AmeriCorps, HUD, Commerce, State, USAID
Retailers and sponsors	SNAP retailer data, meal sponsors	USDA
Customs and trade	Manifests, Census trade data	DHS
Telecom subsidies	USAC open data, FCC broadband map	FCC, Commerce
Benefits (aggregate only)	SOI ZIP data, state and county stats	Treasury, SSA, Labor, PBGC

7 Sources

- USAspending agency list API (FY2026 Q4)
- Treasury Monthly Treasury Statement data (Table 5)
- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments
- GAO-24-105470: SBIR/STTR fraud vulnerabilities
- Partner agencies landscape (the original eight)
- Each agency brief lists its own sources.